

BUDDHISM IS A GUMBALL MACHINE

FEBRUARY 4

I forgot what a tray was for, and started putting memories on it. Then the game was easy — figure out what they have in common. I thought: what if, in XI, two people give memories, and then another person has to come up with what is between them.

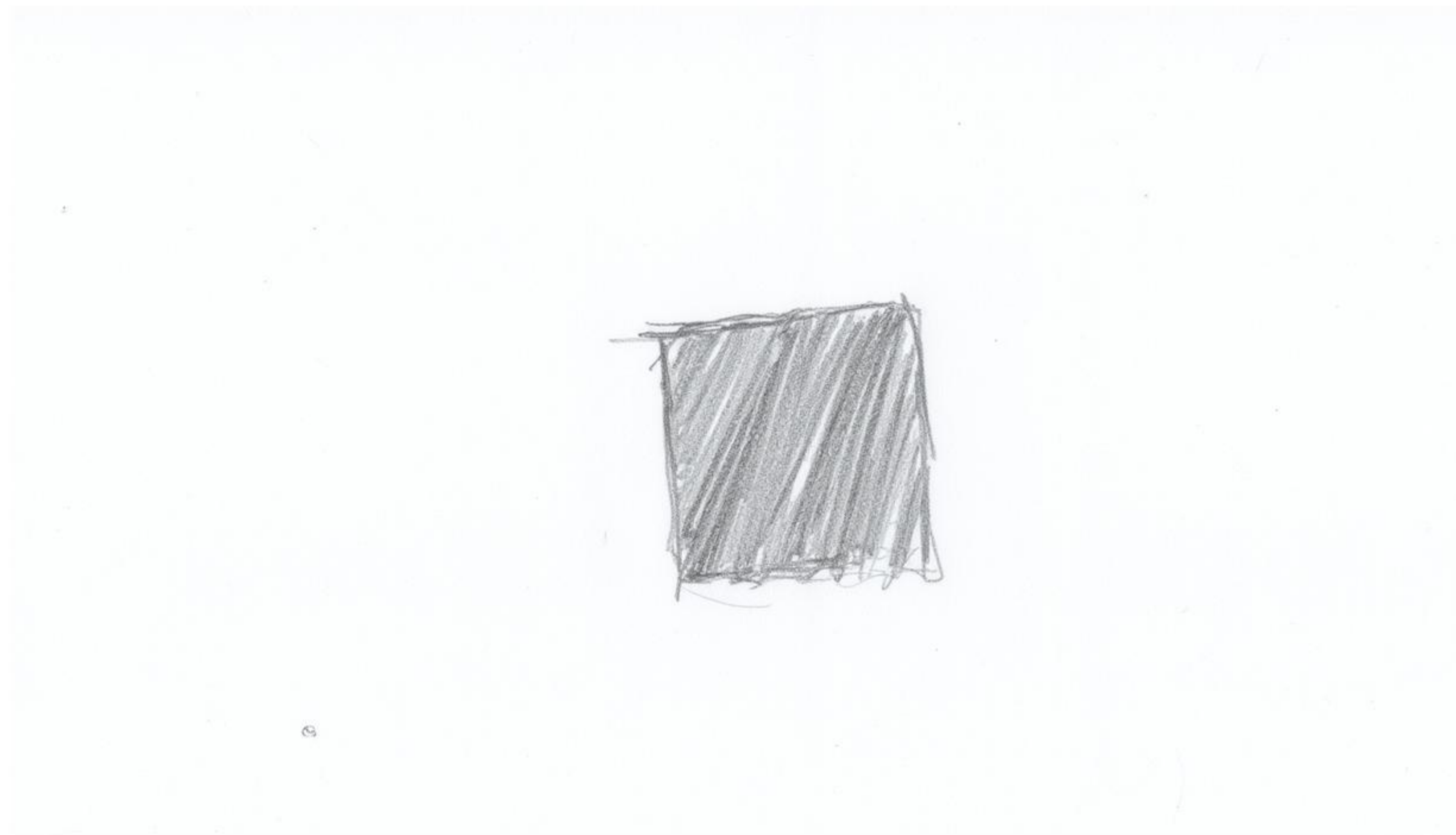
Buddhism is: a gumball machine, where each gumball is a coin. I suppose you don't need the idea if you have the object — "one shiny new nickel" — the object suggests the idea, succinctly. Also allows me to ask: what other objects suggest ideas? The second pattern I'm intentionally collecting.



THE MS PAINT FILL/ERASE METAPHOR

FEBRUARY 1

The metaphor I came up with was: filling MS Paint with black, and then erasing it, section by section. What that has in common with thinking of lots of thoughts just so I can write them down: it's satisfying, and you purposely "mess something up" to get the satisfaction of undoing it.



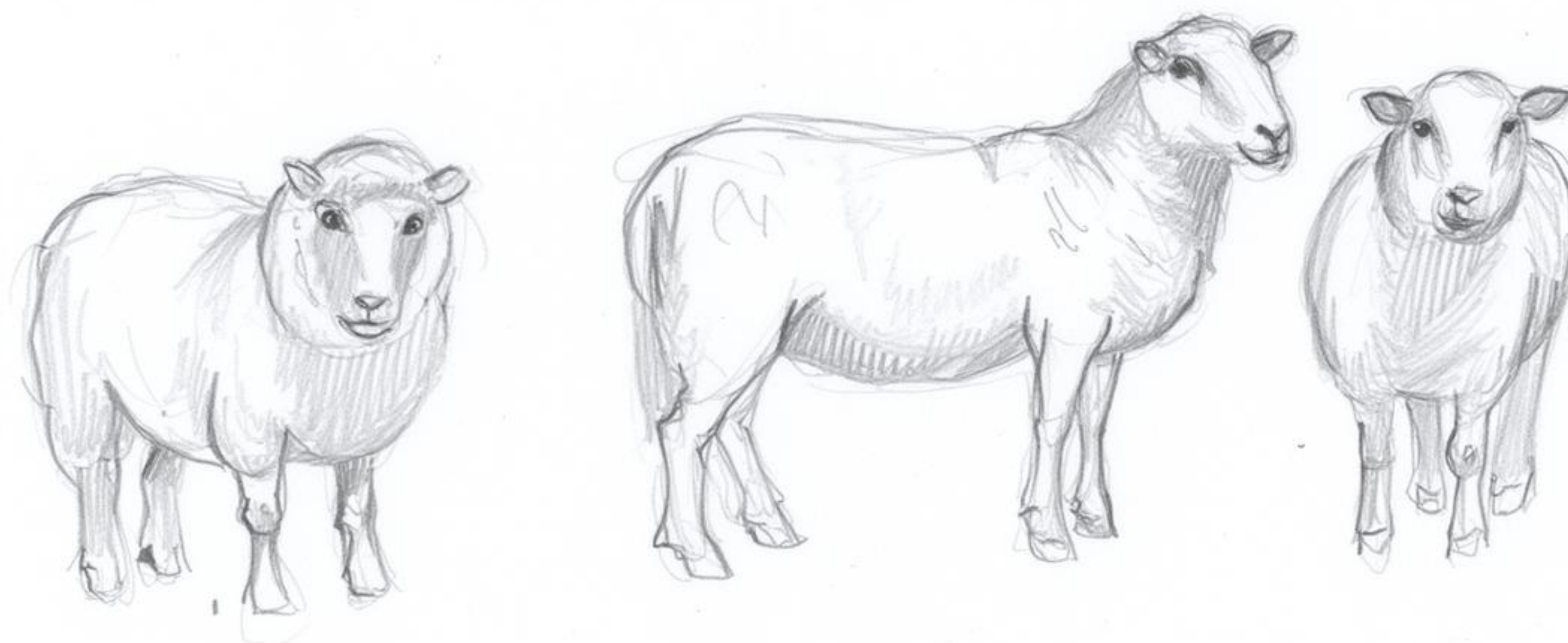
MATH IS JUST HOW WE EXPLAIN THINGS TO OURSELVES

FEBRUARY 3

I tried to explain: you listen to sad songs all day, but even though these are my "top" songs, a higher proportion of the time is spent listening to fun upbeat stuff — it just doesn't get tricked into being in the algorithm, because it's all different.

Then I thought: math is just how we explain things to ourselves. The mode vs. the average vs. the median vs. the mean — I thought of them as 3 colors of sheep, and somehow could make a math problem where it comes out different depending on how you take the "average."

Math is stupid, and we should just realize it's how our brain explains things to us — and maybe look at our brain when it's talking to us, so we don't have to sit through boring math class.

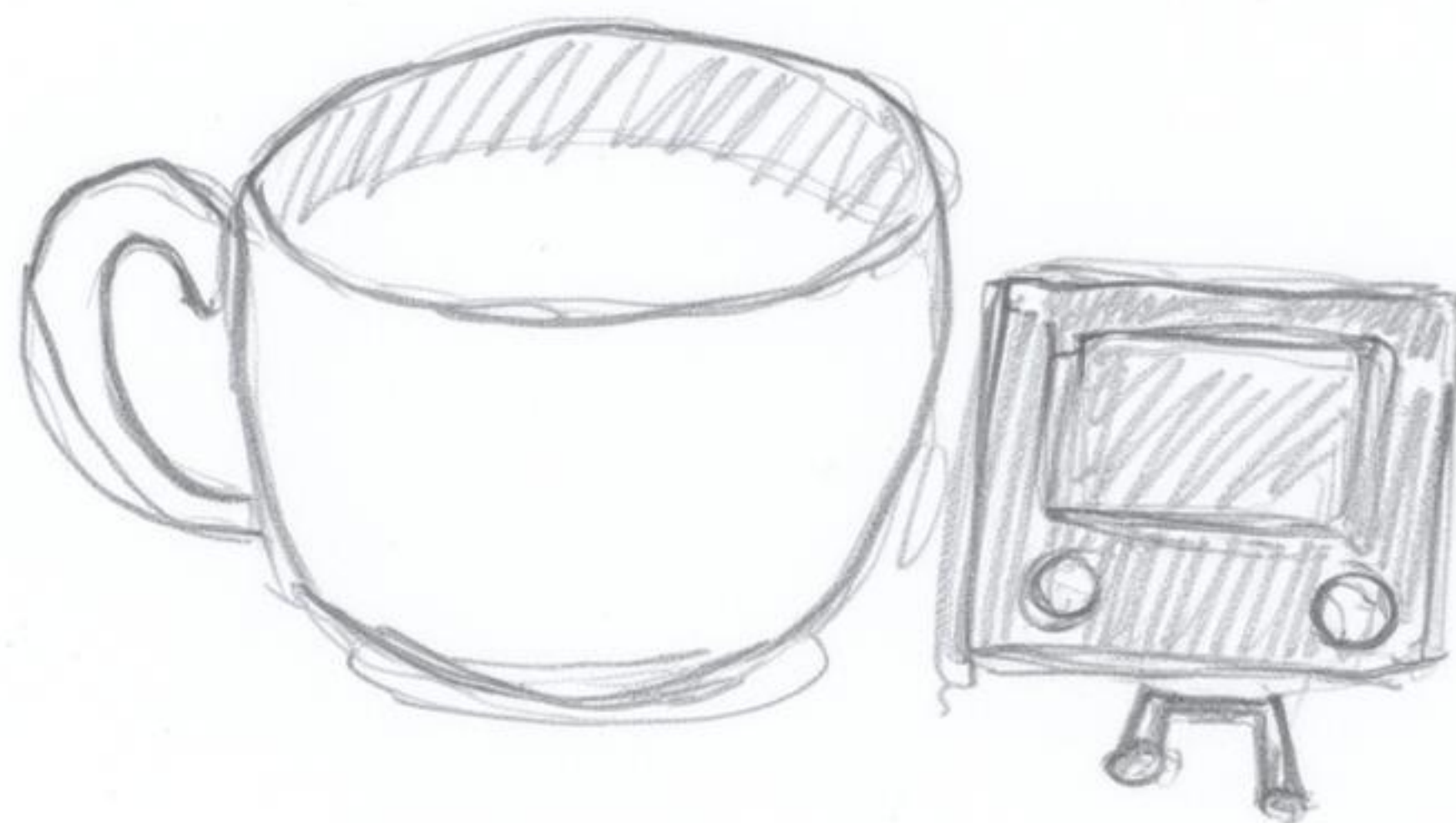


TEACUP VS. ETCH A SKETCH

FEBRUARY 1

I realized that my disorder is like that etching sketching that Sandy used to do, and I want to do the teacup version — I want to be strong like Zeide knows I am.

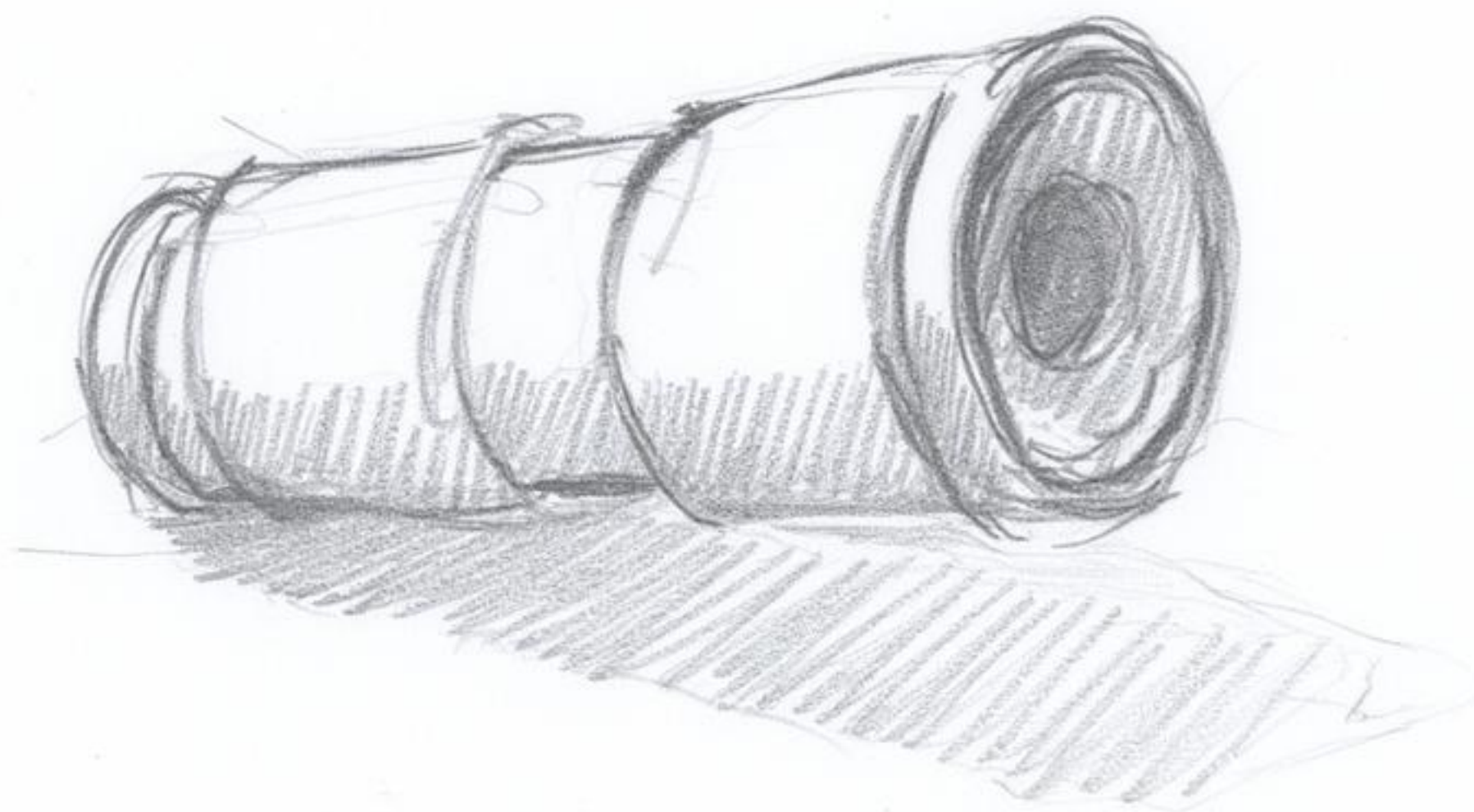
When I was locked, trapped in bed, I tried to be the good strong teacup — one single line, not sketching each decision in the outline of a person, but just: a person, right off the bat. That would be nice. That would be me. And it is me.



THE KALEIDOSCOPE THAT TURNS

MARCH 11

The last part is the kaleidoscope, that turns. You might think it's just a game, and then it goes up and up and up, but one day it's turned upside down, and whatever thought you had — suddenly it all matters, or suddenly it all doesn't.



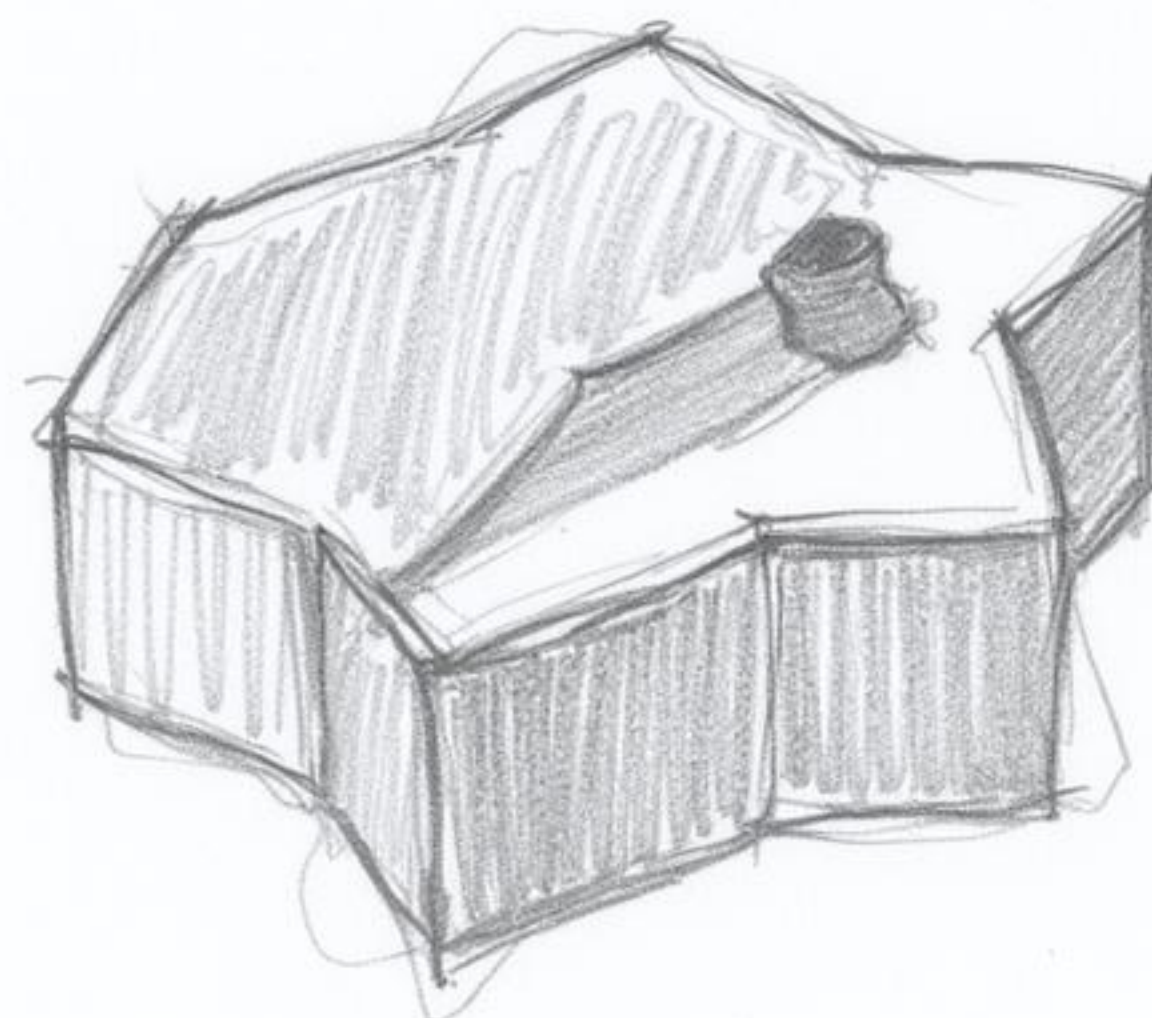
THE STAR OF PARADOX

SEPTEMBER 29

The star of paradox — "it's both a cigarette... and a pill box."

Write, for the website: explain about the star of paradox, and art, in like a paragraph.

The to-do list thing is related to catharsis and how I need him to kiss my forehead when he leaves — a useful bow. Paradox, like jumbo shrimp — it's not. The metaphor sums it up. Ritual.

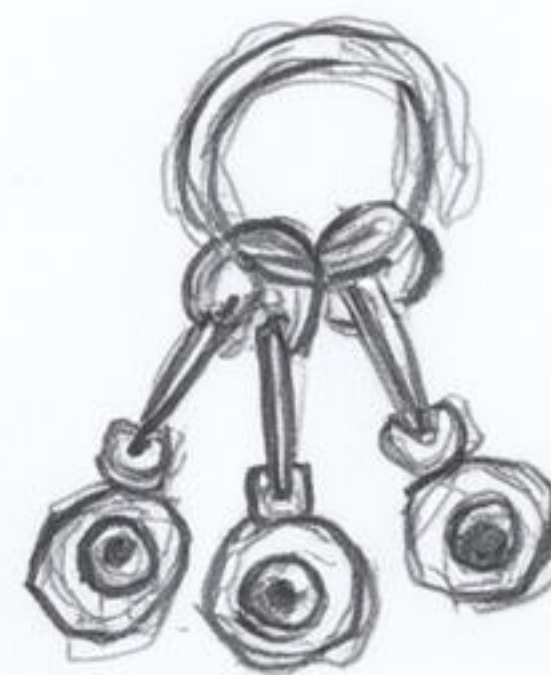


CARRYING THOUGHTS ON KEY RINGS

NOVEMBER 4

The procedure started with collecting 3 eyes, each on little key chains, which I then attached to a ring. Originally it was gonna be a bracelet. But the connotations of keys — you cannot lose them, you take them with you whenever you leave the house — "I am putting them in my picnic basket so I don't forget them for later," and then when you leave: "I am taking them with me so I will have them while I am out."

What connotations do other things have, and how can we be more specific about what slots we fill.



THE MEMORY DRAWER OPENER

DECEMBER 28

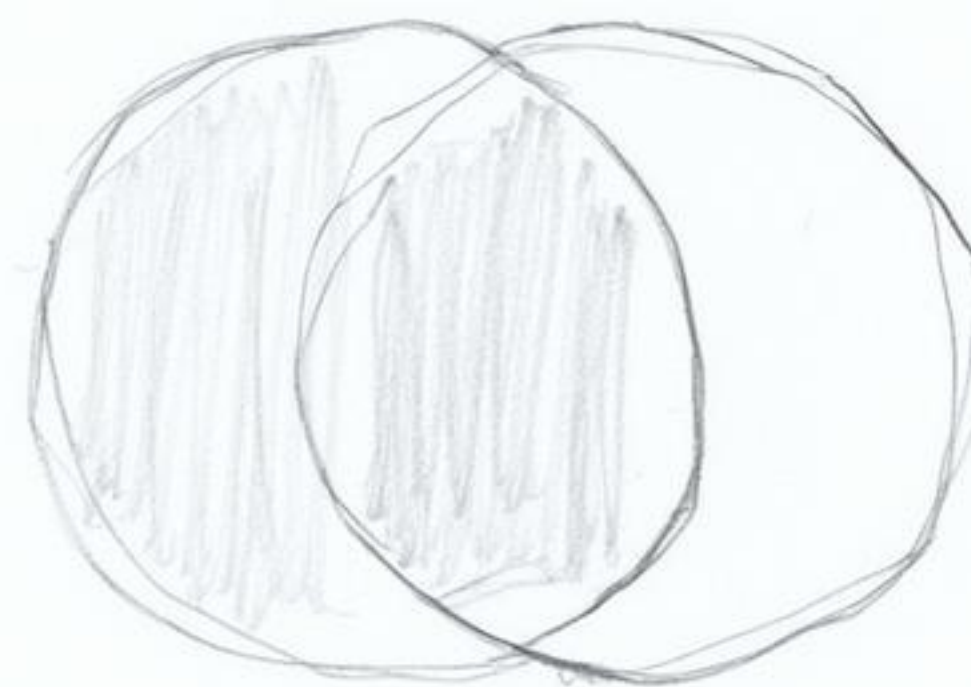
The theory I just solidified is that there's one impetus — a memory drawer opener — and then another label to label the drawer once it's open. For example, "had to prove something in a weird way" — I don't even know the story it's attached to, but it doesn't bring up anything except the Matthew holiday story.



THE SMALL VENN DIAGRAM

MARCH 30

Only a small thing in the ellipse is the idea — that something can be used to refer to, or say something about, something else, even if only a small part is found in common. This concept is often represented by a modified venn diagram, in which the two circles are farther apart so the internal overlap is smaller than average. It allows a larger assortment of metaphors — we relax a rule about how much things must have in common.



VENN DIAGRAMS AS ALGEBRA

FEBRUARY 3

I am really into the transitive property though. The venn diagrams feel like algebra: Serafin changing the light bulbs from white to yellow — "it's more relaxing," he said — and I've been fretting about running out of cream notebooks, and having to use the white ones. Yellow is relaxing.

